LAB 16 — INSTRUCTIONS

Design a Scoped Agent Before You Build It

Topic 04 · Day 4 · Foundation · Copilot Studio, Excel · Alignment K4 · A1

Goal

The learner produces an agent design canvas that states the job the agent does, what it must refuse, the knowledge it may use, the actions it may take and the tests that will prove it behaves.

What you will build

An agent design canvas, a knowledge register, a risk-and-control table and ten acceptance tests

Files supplied in this folder

- Lumina-Living-Lab-16.xlsx — Agent design canvas, knowledge register and test workbook
- Procurement-Policy.docx — The approved procurement policy used as knowledge

Primary prompt

> *Help me scope an agent that answers staff questions about our procurement policy. List the questions it should answer, the questions it must refuse, the knowledge it needs, and the actions it should never take on its own. Ask me for anything you need to know.*

Detailed procedure

Step 1. State the one job the agent does

An agent with one clear job can be tested; an agent that does everything can only be hoped for. Write it as a single sentence in the Design_Canvas sheet.

Step 2. Separate a workflow from an agent

If the path is always the same, build a flow. Choose an agent only when the next step genuinely depends on what the user says.

Step 3. List what the agent must refuse

Write the out-of-scope questions explicitly. An agent with no stated refusals will answer everything, including things it should not.

Step 4. Register the knowledge sources

Record each approved source in Knowledge_Register with its owner. Note that a source you do not add is a source the agent cannot cite.

Step 5. Decide the boundary of agency

For each candidate action, record whether the agent may do it alone, may do it with a human gate, or may never do it.

Step 6. Identify the risks and the control for each

For every risk, name the control. A control the model cannot reach beats an instruction you asked it to follow.

Step 7. Write ten acceptance tests

Write ten concrete test cases with the expected outcome, including at least three that must be refused.

Acceptance test

The canvas states one job, lists explicit refusals, registers every knowledge source with an owner, and carries ten acceptance tests of which at least three expect a refusal.

Evidence to retain

Completed design canvas, knowledge register, risk-and-control table and test list.